

Problem 7: Evoke Kove

(20 marks)

Given below are some sentences in Kove⁵ and their English translations.

yau ngaoli vula pa tuanga	I bought a shell necklace from the village.
veao ukonaghau	You saw me.
Neti ikonari vula noha	Neti saw the shell necklaces yesterday.
Neti ipasolani tuanga pari kekele	Neti showed the children the villages.
yau ngaaniri niu pa tuanga	I ate coconuts in the village.
tamone tipasolaniri vula pa ghau	The men showed me the shell necklaces.
veao upasolani niu pari kaua	You showed the dogs the coconuts.
Neti ihaugho	Neti hit you.
ghaya iani niu lima	The pig ate five coconuts.
yau ngaoli kaua pari tamone	I bought the dogs from the men.
tamone tikona vula tolu	The men saw three shell necklaces.
veai ikonari tamone pa tuanga	He/she saw the men in the villages.

Assignment 1: (8 marks)

Translate the following sentences into Kove.

- (a) Neti ate a coconut.
- (b) I showed you five shell necklaces.
- (c) The pig bought coconuts from the children.
- (d) I saw the villages yesterday.

Assignment 2: (12 marks)

How are words or parts of words put together to form a valid Kove sentence? What are their meanings and functions? (Try to make your explanation fit all of the data. None of the given sentences should be an exception to your answer.)

– Rujul Gandhi

⁵Kove is an Austronesian language spoken by about 6,750 people in the West New Britain province of Papua New Guinea.